

unexpected death of my husband David, my coupon shopping buddy for thirty-two years, in March of 2012. For weeks afterwards, I didn't touch a coupon. I couldn't have cared less about shopping or couponing, despite my need to continue touting the hobby in my workshops and presentations. I couldn't even make it through a grocery store without breaking down in tears. While David hadn't been actively involved in the coupon end and never quite understood how I did my "coupon magic" to bring totals of over two hundred dollars down to less than twenty dollars, he was an eager and supportive companion on the majority of my shopping trips, my helping partner at the recycling bins where we'd collect extra coupon inserts in the early 1990s, and my biggest all-around cheerleader in both my couponing and writing endeavors. His pride in my shopping prowess never ceased to amaze, and sometimes, embarrass me. "Isn't she something?" he'd gush to the cashier at the final tally, slinging his arm around my shoulders affectionately, beaming from ear to ear.

Coupon inserts piled up for several months as I grieved the man who'd encouraged this very book. My priorities shifted dramatically. Who cared about bargain hunting or stockpiling in the face of a tremendous loss? For the first time in thirty years, I ran out of necessities. I had to go on an "emergency run" to the local discount store one evening, horrified to pay full price for feminine protection. Not once in thirty years had I run out of sanitary pads or toothbrushes, and my supply of both products were depleted during the same week.

I wrote this tribute to my husband for a now-defunct refunding bulletin, "Refund Express." Unfortunately, David and I never reached the age of the